

Syed Faiz

HR Head · Business Owner · HR-Tech & AI Builder

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PROFILE

People and operations leader with **10+ years** across retail, merchandising, e-commerce, hospitality and HR. Currently **HR Head** at CJ Clothing, running the people function for **250+ employees across two companies**. Founder and owner of **TALK with T Café**, and the founder and product owner of a **complete HR & payroll SaaS platform** that I designed and built with AI to bring the group's attendance, leave, approvals and payroll in-house. Strong in statutory compliance, process design and turning manual work into reliable systems.

EXPERIENCE

HR Head — CJ Clothing, Bangalore 15 Oct 2025 – Present

- Lead end-to-end HR for **two group companies (250+ employees)**: hiring, onboarding, attendance, leave, payroll, employee relations, confirmations and exits.
- Own monthly **payroll and statutory compliance (PF, ESI, Professional Tax, LWF, TDS)** for both companies, each filing under its own registrations.
- Set up shift rosters, an 8-type leave policy (privilege, sick, comp-off, maternity, paternity, WFH, restricted holiday, LOP) and **biometric attendance** rules.
- Moved all employee, salary-structure and attendance records off the previous HR system into the company's own platform, and **checked computed salaries line by line against the previous system's statements** before relying on them.
- Rolled out **employee self-service** on mobile: payslips, leave, attendance regularisation, tax declarations, help desk and self-onboarding, with one approval console for managers.
- Report directly to the business owner, providing MIS, headcount, attendance and statutory reports for decisions and government filings.

Founder & Product Owner — HRMS & Payroll SaaS Platform (owned by me) Apr 2026 – Present

Designed, built and deployed a **full HR & payroll suite in about 6 months, without a development team**, by directing AI (Claude Code). Live on the group's own server for 250+ employees; commercial launch in progress.

300+ screens	280+ data tables	200 report gallery	65 Excel importers
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- **Payroll engine** with Indian statutory compliance: PF, ESI, PT, LWF and income tax (TDS), plus arrears, loans, overtime, NPS and approval-gated salary revisions.
- **Attendance**: biometric swipe sync, shift rosters, auto-calculated attendance and month-end finalisation to loss-of-pay.
- **One approval console** for 9 request types (leave, regularisation, overtime, resignation, reimbursement, confirmation, help desk and more), with multi-level approvals and delegates.
- **Employee portal**: payslips, tax planner, proof of investment, documents, org chart, company feed and push notifications.
- Run on a Linux server with automated cloud builds, a database backup before every update, automatic rollback and uptime alerts.
- Own the commercial roadmap: brand name, pricing, marketing website and multi-company (multi-tenant) version.

Founder & Business Owner — TALK with T Café, Bangalore

2025 – Present

- Founded and run a **25-seat café** serving pizzas, burgers, fries and beverages. Responsible for concept, set-up, menu and pricing.
- Full **P&L ownership**: purchasing, supplier negotiation, food-cost control, daily cash and accounts.
- Hire, train and schedule the kitchen and service team. Set SOPs for in-house production, hygiene and consistent quality.
- Drive footfall and repeat customers through local and social-media marketing and a focus on customer experience.

Deputy Manager — Titan Company Ltd

2021 – 2023

- Managed product listings and inventory on **Amazon, Flipkart, AJIO and Myntra**.
- Planned and ran marketplace advertising campaigns to improve product visibility and sales.
- Coordinated marketing, warehouse and category teams to keep listings, stock and pricing in sync.

Merchandiser — Sapna Book House

2018 – 2021

- Managed shelf displays, product visibility and timely restocking, keeping **stock accurate across 18 stores**.
- Built monthly sales plans to lift store performance and worked with cross-functional teams on business deliverables.

Store Manager — Raymond

2015 – 2018

- Ran daily store operations, customer service and inventory control.
- Introduced sales-monitoring routines and coached associates. **Met quarterly sales targets** through analysis and planning.

AI SKILLS — HOW I USE AI

Building software by directing AI

Built and shipped a production SaaS (Next.js, PostgreSQL) with Claude Code. I write the requirements, review what it builds and decide what ships.

Checking AI work against real data

Reconciled AI-built payroll against real salary statements. I use 70+ automated checks on live data and a second, independent AI review before work ships.

Rules and memory for AI

Wrote standing rules the AI must follow (compliance, data safety, naming) and handover documents, so any AI or developer can continue the work safely.

Compliance and operations

Built a regulatory-update inbox and dated statutory ceilings (e.g. PF wage ceiling). Automated deployment, uptime alerts and notifications.

Screens to working software

Turned 50+ screenshots of reference HR screens into precise specs, then into working modules, built and verified one batch at a time.

Data migration with AI

Moved a company's full HR history from Excel exports through 65 importers. Every file is test-run and rolled back before anything is saved.

Research and decisions

Ran multi-agent AI research. For the product's brand name, 835 names were screened against domain availability and narrowed to a 4-name shortlist.

Everyday business work

Look up data in the retail ERP (Ginesys) in plain English through AI, turn ERP product masters into upload files, and use AI for Excel analysis, HR letters, policies and SOPs.

CORE SKILLS

HR	Recruitment & onboarding · Payroll & statutory compliance (PF, ESI, PT, LWF, TDS) · Attendance, leave & shift management · HR policies & SOPs · Employee relations & engagement · HR MIS & analytics · HRMS implementation & data migration
Business	P&L management · Retail & store operations · Merchandising · E-commerce marketplaces · Vendor & supplier management · Marketing · Team leadership · Customer service
Technology	Claude Code & AI assistants · Ginesys ERP · MS Office (advanced Excel, Word, PowerPoint) · HRMS & payroll software · Next.js, React, PostgreSQL (through AI) · GitHub & automated builds · Linux server deployment

EDUCATION

- **Bachelor of Business Management (B.B.M.)**
- Class 12 (Pre-University) · Class 10

PERSONAL

- **Languages:** English, Hindi, Kannada, Urdu
- **Interests:** Travelling, snooker, music